



MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

HISTORY BATTLEFIELD TOUR

Course Textbook

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L1: Pre-Trip Information

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

10th Sep

Parent Briefing Meeting

16:15 in the School Hall. Attendance is highly recommended to receive final itineraries and ask any questions.

1. Pre-Trip Briefing

Source A

The Menin Road, a painting by official British War Artist Paul Nash, commissioned in 1919.



Source B

An official Royal Flying Corps aerial photograph showing the intricate trench network on the Western Front, 1916.



Provenance Scaffolding:

Source A is a painting by an official War Artist; does its stylistic and emotional nature make it more or less useful than a photograph? Source B is a military aerial photograph; what makes its objective recording of the geography useful?

Q2. 1 (a). How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the devastated landscape of the Ypres Salient? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of the historical context. (8 marks)

L2: Day 1: Thursday 1st October 2026

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

22:00 Curfew & Room Checks All students in rooms for the night.	20:15 Supervised Free Time Downtime in communal areas.
18:15 Evening Meal Dinner followed by room allocation and settling in.	19:15 Study & Reflection Session Guided review and workbook completion.
13:00 Depart Calais Coach journey to the Ypres Salient.	11:20 Eurotunnel Crossing Transit to Calais (clocks go forward 1 hour).
06:15 Departure from School Travel via Jet Connect executive coach to Folkestone.	17:45 Arrival at Peace Village Accommodation check-in and safety briefing. View hostel details.
15:15 Langemarck German Military Cemetery Guided visit exploring the contrasting design of German burial sites.	09:00 Folkestone Eurotunnel Terminal Check-in and security boarding.
16:00 Hooze Crater Museum & Trenches Museum visit focusing on First World War artefacts, preserved trenches, and field medicine. Visit official website.	14:30 Essex Farm Cemetery & Dressing Station Historical introduction to wartime medical care and Commonwealth war graves.

1. Day 1 Itinerary

The Ypres Salient was a bulge in the Allied frontline that surrounded the Belgian town of Ypres. Because it was a salient, British and Commonwealth troops were surrounded by German artillery on three sides, making it one of the most dangerous places on earth. Ypres was the last major Belgian town not to fall to the Germans, making it a powerful symbol of resistance.

Key Facts:

- Over half a million soldiers died defending a strip of land barely ten miles wide.
- The Salient consisted of thick, heavy clay that, when bombarded by artillery, turned into a deadly, bottomless mud.
- Five major battles were fought here between 1914 and 1918.

Written Source:

"I am no longer an artist interested and curious, I am a messenger who will bring back word from the men who are fighting to those who want the war to go on for ever. It is unspeakable, godless, hopeless."

— **Paul Nash**, British War Artist (1917)



Lt Col John McCrae, author of *In Flanders Fields*

Essex Farm served as an Advanced Dressing Station (ADS). Medical officers worked in cramped, concrete dugouts just hundreds of yards from the fighting to stabilize the wounded before they could be evacuated to hospitals further back.

Key Facts:

- Triage was practiced here: sorting casualties based on the severity of their wounds.

- In May 1915, Canadian surgeon Lt Col John McCrae wrote the famous poem *In Flanders Fields* while stationed here after burying his friend Alexis Helmer.
- Valentine Joe Strudwick, one of the youngest casualties of the war at just 15 years old, is buried here.

Unlike the bright, white Portland stone of British cemeteries, German cemeteries like Langemarck are intentionally somber, shaded by large oak trees and featuring dark stone blocks, reflecting Germanic mourning traditions.

Task Locked

Enter the Langemarck gates to unlock your assigned individual.

Hooge was the site of intense, close-quarters fighting. The opposing trenches were so close that soldiers could hear each other speaking. In July 1915, the British detonated a massive underground mine beneath the German lines, creating a massive crater.

Key Facts:

- The mine blast created a crater 120 feet wide and 20 feet deep.
- Soldiers in these trenches suffered terribly from 'trench foot' due to standing in freezing mud and water for days on end.

Written Source:

"The trench was a ribbon of earth, filled with freezing water, the stench of unburied bodies, and the constant, nerve-shredding crack of sniper fire."

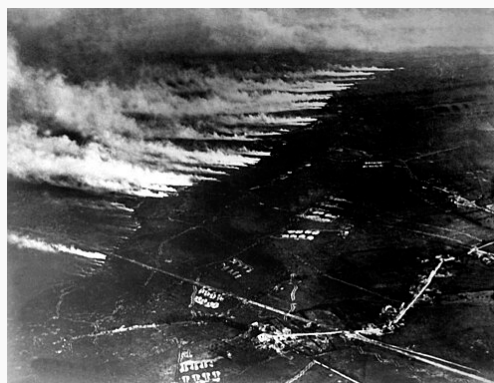
— **Private Frank Richards**, Royal Welch Fusiliers

Source A

A photograph taken by official war photographer Frank Hurley showing Australian soldiers walking along a duckboard track through the shattered landscape of Chateau Wood during the Battle of Passchendaele, 1917.

Source B

An aerial photograph showing clouds of poison gas rolling across the battlefield during a chemical attack on the Western Front.



Provenance Scaffolding:

Source A was taken by an official photographer known for dramatic compositions; does this limit its usefulness or perfectly capture the reality of the mud? Source B is an aerial photograph of a gas attack; what makes this detached, wide-angle view of the battlefield useful for understanding the scale of chemical warfare?

Q2. 1 (a). How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the difficult conditions faced by the medical services at Passchendaele and Ypres? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of the historical context. (8 marks)

L3: Day 2: Friday 2nd October 2026

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

20:30

Return to Accommodation

Supervised free time.

22:00

Curfew & Room Checks

All students in rooms for the night.

18:00

Evening Meal

Dinner at accommodation.

09:45

Sanctuary Wood & Preserved Trenches

Exploration of original trench systems (sturdy footwear advised).

09:15

The Brooding Soldier

Visit to the Canadian memorial at St Julien (First Gas Attack, 1915).

14:15

Lijssenthoek Visitors Centre & Cemetery

	Study of casualty clearing stations and battlefield medicine. Visit official website.
09:00 Depart for Battlefield Sites Board coach for full day of guided study.	19:00 Menin Gate, Ypres Attend the historic 20:00 Last Post Ceremony, including official wreath laying by nominated students. Last Post Association.
08:00 Breakfast Provided at accommodation.	17:30 Return to Peace Village Downtime and preparation for evening event.
13:00 Tyne Cot British Cemetery Guided visit to the world's largest Commonwealth war cemetery.	15:45 Passchendaele Museum (Zonnebeke) Immersive museum tour and dugout experience. Visit official website.
11:30 Supervised Lunch Stop Stop in Ypres to purchase packed lunch and snacks.	

1. Day 2 Itinerary

In April 1915, the Germans launched the first major poison gas attack of the war on the Western Front at St Julien. A heavy cloud of chlorine gas was released, devastating the French colonial troops and forcing the Canadian 1st Division to step in and hold the line.

Task Locked

Walk into the memorial grounds to unlock your reflection task./p>

Sanctuary Wood was initially a quiet area behind the lines where soldiers could rest (a sanctuary), but it eventually became part of the frontline. Today, it offers a rare look at an original, preserved trench system.

Key Facts:

- Trenches here were reinforced with corrugated metal ('elephant iron') to prevent collapse in the waterlogged soil.
- The shattered, dead trees preserved in the wood are a direct result of relentless artillery fire tearing the landscape apart.
- **Local Connection:** Just a short distance from here is Westhoek Ridge, where Stubbington local Auriol 'Eric' Lowry fought in 1917.

Written Source:

"I died in hell—(They called it Passchendaele). My wound was slight, / And I was hobbling back; and then a shell / Burst slick upon the duck-boards: so I fell / Into the bottomless mud, and lost the light."

— **Siegfried Sassoon**, Memorial Tablet



Tyne Cot Cemetery

Tyne Cot is the largest Commonwealth war cemetery in the world, reflecting the incomprehensible scale of the casualties during the Battle of Passchendaele (1917).

Task Locked

Walk through the cemetery gates to unlock your assigned soldier.

Lijssenthoek was the largest evacuation hospital in the Ypres Salient. Located just out of artillery range, it received casualties directly from the frontline dressing stations.

Key Facts:

- It handled over 200,000 casualties during the war.
- The cemetery graves provide a timeline of hospital mortality, showing spikes during major offensives.
- Advances in treating infection happened here, including the Carrel-Dakin method of flushing wounds with antiseptics.
- Nurses also lost their lives here, such as Staff Nurse Nellie Spindler who was killed by a shell.



The Menin Gate, Ypres

The Menin Gate is a colossal memorial to the missing in Ypres. Millions of Allied soldiers marched through this spot on their way to the frontlines, and many never returned.

Task Locked

Walk under the arches of the Menin Gate to unlock your reflection task./p>

Source A

A photograph showing the complete destruction of the Cloth Hall in the Ypres town square, 1918.

Source B

A photograph of British soldiers relaxing and drinking tea inside Talbot House (Toc H) in Poperinge.



Provenance Scaffolding:

Source A is a factual photograph documenting structural damage; what can it tell us about the destructive power of artillery? Source B shows men resting at Talbot House; why was this 'Every Man's Club' so vital for morale just a few miles behind the front line?

Q2. 1 (a). How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the impact of the war on the town of Ypres and the importance of rest for the soldiers? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of the historical context. (8 marks)

L4: Day 3: Saturday 3rd October 2026

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

08:00

Breakfast & Packing

Breakfast, room handover, and loading coach.

20:00 approx.

Return to School

Arrival back at Meoncross School for collection.

14:30

Depart for Calais

Return journey to Eurotunnel terminal.

17:50

Eurotunnel Crossing

Calais to Folkestone (arrives 17:30 UK time).

09:15

Menin Gate & Ramparts Walk

Daytime study of memorial panels and walk to Ypres Ramparts Cemetery.

13:30

Poperinge Town Hall

Visit to preserved death cells and military justice sites.

11:20

Talbot House, Poperinge

Tour of the famous British soldiers' rest house and club. [Visit official website.](#)

12:45

Lunch in Poperinge

Supervised lunch stop in the town centre.

10:30

Ypres Town Square

Supervised visit to a traditional Belgian chocolatier.

1. Day 3 Itinerary

The medieval ramparts of Ypres provided some of the only cover in the destroyed city. Soldiers dug deep into the ancient moated defenses to hide from the shelling. The Ramparts Cemetery is one of the most picturesque on the Western Front, built directly into the town's defenses.

Written Source:

"Who will remember, passing through this Gate, / The unheroic dead who fed the guns? / Who shall absolve the foulness of their fate..."

— **Siegfried Sassoon**, On Passing the New Menin Gate

Located in the town of Poperinge, safely behind the lines, Talbot House was set up by Army Chaplain Tubby Clayton as an 'Every Man's Club'. It was an oasis of sanity where soldiers could escape the psychological horror of the trenches.

Key Facts:

- Rank was completely ignored here; signs read 'Abandon Rank All Ye Who Enter Here'.
- Soldiers could drink tea, write letters, use the library, and attend services in the attic chapel.
- Over half a million men passed through its doors.

A stark contrast to Talbot House, the nearby Poperinge Town Hall contains the death cells and an execution post used by the British Army. Discipline was incredibly harsh, and shell shock was poorly understood by the high command.

Key Facts:

- Over 300 British and Commonwealth soldiers were executed by firing squad during the war, often for 'cowardice' or 'desertion'.
- Many of these men were actually suffering from severe psychological trauma (shell shock) caused by the relentless artillery bombardment.
- In 2006, the British Government issued a mass statutory pardon for all soldiers executed for military offenses during the First World War.

L5: Private T. J. Franklin

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Resting Place Menin Gate, Ypres Killed 29th April 1915 holding an exposed line on the Frezenberg Ridge.
Memorial Stubbington War Memorial Commemorated in the village center.

Home Stubbington Connection Lived at Meadow Cottage, Chark
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1. The Life and Fall of Private T. J. Franklin

Service Number: 8560

Regiment: 1st Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: Alverstoke, Hampshire, in about 1893.

Local Connection: He was the son of George Franklin (an Army Pensioner and farm labourer) and Mary Ann Jane Franklin. The family lived at Chark Cottage in Stubbington, and later moved to Meadow Cottage, Chark, Lee-on-the-Solent. By 1911, Thomas was serving in Wellington Lines, Aldershot.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Gosport. He was deployed to the Western Front in August 1914, earning the 1914 Star. He was killed in action on **29th April 1915** during the Second Battle of Ypres. His battalion was holding an exposed section of the line on the Frezenberg Ridge (east of St Julien) to cover an Allied withdrawal, enduring intense German shelling and the first ever military poison gas attacks.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L6: Private W. Ayling

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Memorial Stubbington War Memorial Commemorated in the village center.
Resting Place Menin Gate, Ypres Killed 9th July 1915 during heavy trench mortar bombardment.

Home Stubbington Connection Lived in Stubbington Lane; worked as a Baker Boy
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1. The Life and Fall of Private W. Ayling

Service Number: 9330

Rank: Private (commemorated on the Holy Rood Memorial Tablet as a Lance Corporal, though official war records register him as a Private).

Regiment: 1st Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: About 1895 in Hindhead, Surrey.

Local Connection: He was the second son of Horace Ayling (a head cowman) and Annie Ayling. The family moved to Stubbington around 1907, residing in a crowded 13-person household in Stubbington Lane, where William worked as a local baker boy.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Winchester. He crossed to France in August 1914, earning the 1914 Star. He was killed by shell fire on **9th July 1915** (only a few months after his battalion comrade, Private Franklin). His company was heavily shelled and hit with trench mortars during an action to relieve captured enemy trenches north of Ypres.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L7: Private S. Muckett

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Memorial Stubbington War Memorial Commemorated in the village center.	Home Stubbington Connection Lived at Brown's Farm; worked as a Grocer's Errand Boy
Resting Place Tyne Cot British Cemetery Killed 20th September 1917 during the Battle of Menin Road Ridge.	

1. The Life and Fall of Private S. Muckett

Service Number: 12977

Rank: Private (listed as a Corporal on the Holy Rood Memorial, but registered as a Private in official war records).

Regiment: 15th (Service) Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: 26th December 1895 at Titchfield.

Local Connection: He was the son of William Muckett (a farm labourer) and Elizabeth Muckett. They lived at Pound Knap, Crofton, and Brown's Farm, Stubbington, where Sydney worked as a grocer's errand boy, before relocating to Melville Gate, Stubbington. His sister Louisa Annie and brother Frank both married into the local Rye family.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Fareham in 1914. He was killed in action, aged 21, on **20th September 1917** during the Battle of Menin Road Ridge. His battalion went over the top south of Ypres, advancing rapidly under fire to clear a German strongpoint at Java Avenue.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L8: Private A. Rye

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Resting Place Tyne Cot British Cemetery Killed 26th September 1917 at Polygon Wood.	Memorial Stubbington War Memorial Commemorated in the village center.
Home Stubbington Connection Lived at Lower Crabthorne; Nurseryman	

1. The Life and Fall of Private A. Rye

Service Number: 22926

Regiment: 14th Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: 1897 at Forest Side, Sussex.

Local Connection: He was the youngest child of Charles Rye (a farm labourer) and Jane Rye. The family lived at Stroud Green, Stubbington. By 1911, Arthur was living at Lower Crabthorne, Hill Head, working as a local nurseryman. His sister Alice married Frank Muckett (brother of Private Sydney Muckett).

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted at Fareham. He was killed in action, aged 21, on **26th September 1917**—only nine days after his brother-in-law's brother, Sydney Muckett, was killed. His battalion attacked near the Menin Road, advancing through Tower Hamlets under heavy mist to consolidate their objectives.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium, on the exact same panels as Sydney Muckett (neither body was ever recovered).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L9: Lance Corporal A. Ward

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Home Stubbington Connection Lived at Balmoral, Gosport Road	Resting Place Tyne Cot British Cemetery Killed 14th October 1918 advancing in thick mist.
Memorial Stubbington War Memorial Commemorated in the village center.	

1. The Life and Fall of Lance Corporal A. Ward

Service Number: 17568

Regiment: 15th (Hampshire Yeomanry) Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: 1896 in Alverstoke.

Local Connection: He was the son of Hugh Ward (a Royal Navy Coastguard and yacht steward) and Bertha Kathleen Ward. The family lived at 6 Coastguard Cottages, Hill Head, and later Balmoral, Gosport Road, Lee-on-the-Solent. His younger brother, Horace Vivian Ward, was also killed in action.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted in Portsmouth. He fought on the Western Front, in Italy, and returned to France in March 1918. He was killed in action, aged 23, on **14th October 1918**—less than a month before the Armistice. During the final Allied advance from Gheluwe towards Courtrai, Belgium, his battalion advanced through thick mist under a harassing barrage to overcome German pillboxes.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L10: Private C. Warland

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Resting Place Tyne Cot British Cemetery Killed 4th October 1917 taking Juniper Trench.	Memorial Stubbington War Memorial Commemorated in the village center.
Home Stubbington Connection Lived at Canford	

1. The Life and Fall of Private C. Warland

Service Number: T/202335

Regiment: 3/4th Battalion, The Queen's (Royal West Surrey) Regiment

Born: 1897 at Richmond, Surrey.

Local Connection: He was the son of John Alfred Henry Warland (a sporting journalist, author, Secretary of the Lee-on-the-Solent Golf Club, and parish councillor) and Louise Clara Warland. The family lived at Canford, Lee-on-the-Solent.

Military Service & Fate: Enlisted in Richmond, Surrey. He was killed in action, aged 20, on **4th October 1917** during an assault south-east of Polygon Wood. His battalion advanced across the Polygonebeek marsh to capture Juniper Trench and a blockhouse under a continuous and heavy German artillery barrage.

Memorial Site: Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L11: The Final Teacher Challenge

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Synthesize learning from various historical sites into a cohesive understanding of the Great War.

As we conclude our journey through the Ypres Salient, it is time to bring the stories of the fallen back home. Your final challenge is to choose one of the local heroes we investigated and write a short memorial speech that could be read aloud at the Stubbington War Memorial on Remembrance Sunday.

Your speech must:

- State who they were and where they lived.
- Describe the conditions they faced on the battlefield.
- Explain why their sacrifice, and the sacrifice of their generation, must never be forgotten.

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